Himaayah Schools
MADRASAH

GUIDE

إِنَّ الصَّلَاةَ كَانَتْ عَلَى الْمُؤْمِنِينَ كِتَابًا مَّوْقُوتًا

"Indeed, prayer has been decreed upon the believers at fixed times." (an-Nisāʾ 4:103)

Ṭahārah and Ṣalāh

Purification and prayer in the Mālikī school, step by step: water, wuḍūʾ, ghusl, tayammum, the prayer and sujūd as-sahw.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Before you begin

The prayer is the second pillar of Islām and the first deed a person will be asked about on the Day of Judgement. The Prophet ﷺ said: "The first of his deeds for which a servant will be called to account on the Day of Resurrection is his prayer. If it is sound, he will have succeeded and prospered; if it is unsound, he will have failed and lost" (at-Tirmidhī 413, an-Nasāʾī 465). And the prayer is not accepted without purification: "Allah does not accept a prayer without purification" (Muslim, 224).

This guide teaches both, according to the school of **Imām Mālik ibn Anas**, the Imām of Madinah, whose school is followed across North and West Africa. It follows the order and rulings of the classic beginners' texts taught in our Madrasah: **al-Akhḍarī**, **al-Muqaddimah al-ʿAshmāwiyyah** and the **Risālah** of Ibn Abī Zayd al-Qayrawānī.

How to use this guide

Read it with a teacher, and practise each part as you learn it: make wuḍūʾ while reading the wuḍūʾ chapter, pray while reading the prayer chapter.

The words **farḍ**, **sunnah** and **faḍīlah** (or mandūb) have exact meanings in the Mālikī school, explained on the next page. Learn them first, because the rulings on mistakes depend on them.

Where the scholars of the school differ, the well-known view (al-mashhūr) is given. If your teacher teaches another accepted view, follow your teacher.

The rulings you will meet

Term	Meaning	Example
Farḍ / wājib	Obligatory. Leaving it deliberately is sinful, and leaving a farḍ of wuḍūʾ or the prayer makes it invalid.	Washing the face in wuḍūʾ; al-Fātiḥah in the prayer
Sunnah	A confirmed practice of the Prophet ﷺ. Rewarded if done; blameworthy to leave habitually. In the prayer, forgetting some sunan calls for sujūd as-sahw.	Rinsing the mouth in wuḍūʾ; the sūrah after al-Fātiḥah
Faḍīlah / mandūb	Recommended. Rewarded if done, no blame if left.	Siwāk; qunūt in Fajr
Makrūh	Disliked. Rewarded for leaving it; not sinful to do.	Looking around in the prayer
Ḥarām	Forbidden. Sinful to do.	Praying without wuḍūʾ deliberately

Contents

01 **Water and najāsah**
Which water purifies, what is impure, and istinjāʾ

02 **Wuḍūʾ**
Its farāʾiḍ, sunan, faḍāʾil and what breaks it

03 **Ghusl**
When it is obligatory and how to do it

04 **Tayammum and wiping over khuffs**
Purification when water cannot be used

05 **The prayer: times and conditions**
The five times, covering the ʿawrah, the qiblah

06 **The prayer: farāʾiḍ, sunan and faḍāʾil**
What makes a prayer valid, complete and excellent

07 **The prayer step by step**
Two rakʿahs of Fajr, with the Arabic

08 **What spoils the prayer, and sujūd as-sahw**
Mistakes, doubts and how to repair them

09 **Travel, missed prayers and Jumuʿah**
Shortening, combining and making up

10 **Self-test and further study**

Part 1 Water and najāsah

Three kinds of water

Kind	Ruling	Example
Muṭlaq (plain water)	Pure and purifies. The only water for wuḍū', ghusl and removing najāsah.	Rain, well, river, sea, tap water, melted snow
Changed by something pure	Pure, but does not purify, if its colour, taste or smell has changed by something mixed into it.	Tea, juice, water with soap or milk in it
Changed by najāsah	Impure: cannot be used for anything in worship.	Water whose colour, taste or smell has changed because of urine or blood

In the Mālikī school, water does not become impure merely because najāsah falls into it, whether the water is little or much, unless one of its three qualities (colour, taste or smell) changes. Using a little water that a little najāsah fell into, without changing it, is disliked (makrūh) when other water is available. Water changed by things it naturally sits on, such as clay, moss or rust in its channel, is still muṭlaq.

What is najis (impure)?

- The **urine and faeces** of humans, and of animals whose meat may not be eaten. (The urine and dung of animals whose meat is eaten, such as cattle, sheep and chickens, are pure in the Mālikī school, unless the animal feeds on najāsah.)
- **Blood** that flows, **pus**, and **vomit** that has changed from the state of food.
- **Madhy** (thin fluid from desire), **wady** (thick white fluid after urinating) and, in the Mālikī school, **manī** (semen).
- The **dead body** of an animal that died without proper slaughter, except creatures of the sea, creatures with no flowing blood (such as flies and ants) and the human being.
- **Pork**, and **intoxicating drink**.

A living dog is pure in the Mālikī school. Washing a vessel seven times when a dog has drunk from it is done as an act of worship, following the ḥadīth (al-Bukhārī 172, Muslim 279), not because the dog is impure.

Removing najāsah

Removing najāsah from the body, clothes and place of prayer is obligatory for the one who **remembers** it and is **able** to remove it. It is washed with plain water until its substance is gone; a trace of colour or smell that is hard to remove is excused. Some najāsah is excused because it is hard to avoid: blood less than the size of a dirham, the blood of a wound that keeps flowing, and splashes of street water.

If you prayed with najāsah

If you prayed with najāsah on your clothes or body because you **forgot** it or **did not know** of it, your prayer is valid, but it is recommended to repeat it while its time remains. If you prayed with it **deliberately** while able to remove it, repeat the prayer.

Istinjāʾ: cleaning after the toilet

After relieving oneself, the place is cleaned with **water** (istinjāʾ), or with **stones or tissue** (istijmār), or best of all with both: first tissue, then water. Istijmār is enough for urine and faeces that have not spread far beyond the outlet, using an odd number of wipes, at least three is recommended, until the place is clean. Water is required for madhy (washing the whole organ, with intention, in the Mālikī school), for menstrual blood, and when the najāsah has spread. Use the **left hand**, enter the toilet with the left foot saying "**Bismillāh, Allāhumma innī aʿūdhu bika mina al-khubuthi wa al-khabāʾith**", leave with the right foot saying "**Ghufrānak**" (al-Bukhārī 142; Abū Dāwūd 30), and do not face or turn your back to the qiblah in open land.

Part 2 Wuḍūʾ

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِذَا قُمْتُمْ إِلَى الصَّلَاةِ فَاغْسِلُوا
وُجُوهَكُمْ وَأَيْدِيَكُمْ إِلَى الْمَرَافِقِ وَامْسَحُوا
بِرُءُوسِكُمْ وَأَرْجُلَكُمْ إِلَى الْكَعْبَيْنِ

“O you who believe, when you rise to pray, wash your faces and your hands to the elbows, wipe your heads, and wash your feet to the ankles.”

Al-Māʾidah 5:6.

The seven farāʾiḍ of wuḍūʾ

1. **Intention (niyyah)** at the start, in the heart: to remove the ḥadath, or to make permissible what needs wuḍūʾ, or to perform the obligation of wuḍūʾ. It is not spoken aloud.
2. **Washing the face**: from where the hair normally grows to the end of the chin, and from ear to ear. A thin beard is washed through to the skin; a thick beard is washed over and its hairs moved with the hand.
3. **Washing the arms to the elbows**, including the elbows, and running the fingers of one hand through the other (takhlīl), which is obligatory for the fingers.
4. **Wiping the whole head**, from the front hairline to the nape. (A woman wipes over her hair, including what hangs down.)
5. **Washing the feet to the ankles**, including the ankles. Running the fingers between the toes is recommended.
6. **Rubbing (dalk)**: passing the hand over each limb with the water, or just after it, while it is wet.
7. **Continuity (al-fawr, al-muwālāh)**: washing the limbs one after another without a long break, for the one who remembers and is able. If you forget and the gap is long, build on what you did; if you deliberately leave a long gap, start again.

The sunan of wuḍūʾ

- Washing the **hands to the wrists** at the start
- Rinsing the **mouth** (maḍmaḍah)
- Sniffing water into the **nose** (istinshāq)
- Blowing it out (**istinthār**)
- **Returning** the wipe of the head: from the back to the front
- Wiping the **ears**, inside and out
- Taking **new water** for the ears

- **Order (tartīb)** between the farāʾiḍ: face, arms, head, feet

The faḍāʾil (recommended acts)

Saying **Bismillāh** at the start; using the **siwāk**; washing each limb a **second and third time** (never more than three); starting with the **right**; beginning the wipe of the head from the **front**; keeping the order of the sunan; using **little water**; doing it in a clean place; and saying after it:

> أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلٰهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَحْدَهُ لَا شَرِيكَ لَهُ، وَأَشْهَدُ أَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا عَبْدُهُ وَرَسُولُهُ
>
> **"I bear witness that there is no god but Allah alone, without partner, and I bear witness that Muḥammad is His servant and His Messenger."**
>
> Whoever says it after a complete wuḍūʾ, the eight gates of Paradise are opened for him, to enter by whichever he wishes (Muslim, 234).

Wuḍūʾ step by step

1. Intend in your heart and say **Bismillāh**.
2. Wash your **hands** to the wrists three times.
3. Rinse your **mouth** three times, then sniff water into your **nose** and blow it out, three times.
4. Wash your **face** three times, rubbing it.
5. Wash your **right arm** to and including the elbow three times, running your fingers between each other; then the **left**.
6. Wipe your **head** once: wet hands from the front of the head to the nape, and back to the front.
7. Wipe your **ears** with fresh water: index fingers inside, thumbs behind.
8. Wash your **right foot** to and including the ankle three times, rubbing it and passing your little finger between the toes; then the **left**.
9. Say the **shahādah** above.

What breaks wuḍūʾ

Kind	What it includes
Events (aḥdāth): what comes out	Urine, faeces, wind, madhy and wady. (Manī requires ghusl.) Something that comes out continually, like urine incontinence, does not break wuḍūʾ if it is present most of the time; washing for each prayer is then recommended.
Causes (asbāb): what leads to an event	Loss of consciousness: heavy sleep, fainting, madness, intoxication. Light sleep does not break it. Touching a person one could find pleasure in, with the intention of pleasure or finding it. Kissing on the mouth. Touching one's own private organ with the palm or the inside of the fingers.
Others	Apostasy. And doubt: if you were sure you had wuḍūʾ and then doubt whether you broke it, the Mālikī school says renew it (unless you suffer from constant waswās).

Bleeding, vomiting, cupping, eating camel meat or laughing in the prayer do **not** break wuḍūʾ in the Mālikī school (laughing aloud breaks the prayer itself). Without wuḍūʾ it is forbidden to **pray**, to make **ṭawāf**, and to **touch the muṣḥaf**, except for a student or teacher who needs it for learning.

Part 3 Ghusl

When ghusl is obligatory

- **Janābah**: the emission of manī with customary pleasure, awake or asleep; and intercourse, even without emission.
- **The end of ḥayḍ and nifās** (see our guide The Fiqh of Ḥayḍ, Nifās and Istiḥāḍah).
- **Death**: the living wash the Muslim who has died, except the martyr killed in battle.
- **Entering Islām**: the school holds that the new Muslim performs ghusl.

Ghusl is a **sunnah** for Jumuʿah (connected to going to the prayer), for the two ʿĪds, and for iḥrām. If you wake and find wetness you are sure is manī, ghusl is obligatory even if you do not remember a dream; if you remember a dream but find nothing, it is not.

The farāʾiḍ of ghusl

1. **Intention** at the start.
2. **Covering the whole body with water**, including the hair to its roots and the folds of the skin.
3. **Rubbing (dalk)** the whole body, as far as you can reach, by hand or with a cloth.
4. **Continuity**, as in wuḍūʾ.
5. **Running the fingers through the hair** (takhlīl), so the water reaches the skin. A woman need not undo her braids if the water reaches the roots.

Sunan of ghusl: washing the hands to the wrists first; rinsing the mouth; sniffing water and blowing it out; and wiping the **ear canals** (ṣimākh).

Ghusl step by step

1. Intend, and say **Bismillāh**.
2. Wash your **hands** three times.
3. Wash away any **najāsah**, then wash your **private parts**, with the intention of ghusl (so you do not touch them again).
4. Make a complete **wuḍū**ʾ. (You may delay washing the feet until the end.)
5. Pour water over your **head** three times, running your fingers through the hair to the roots.
6. Wash the **right side** of your body from top to bottom, then the **left**, rubbing as you go. Make sure the water reaches the navel, armpits, behind the ears and knees, and between the toes.
7. Wash your **feet**, if you delayed them.

If you touch your private organ with your palm after washing it and before finishing, renew your wuḍūʾ (but not the ghusl) before you pray. The junub may not pray, make ṭawāf, touch the muṣḥaf, stay in the masjid or recite the Qur'an, except a few verses for protection or ruqyah.

Part 4 Tayammum and wiping over khuffs

فَلَمْ تَجِدُوا مَاءً فَتَيَمَّمُوا صَعِيدًا طَيِّبًا فَامْسَحُوا بِوُجُوهِكُمْ وَأَيْدِيكُم مِّنْهُ

"...and you find no water, then seek clean earth and wipe your faces and hands with it."

Al-Mā'idah 5:6.

Who may make tayammum

- The **sick** person who fears that water will harm him, increase his illness or delay his recovery.
- The **traveller** who has no water, or only enough to drink.
- The **resident** who cannot find water, or fears the prayer time will end before he reaches it: he makes tayammum for the obligatory prayers.
- Anyone who cannot reach water for fear of a thief, a wild animal or the like.

Tayammum is made with **ṣaʿīd ṭayyib**: clean earth, dust, sand, stone, gravel or anything of the earth that has not been cooked or processed. In the Mālikī school it is made only **after the prayer time has begun**, and each **obligatory prayer** needs its own tayammum, though one may pray sunnah prayers after the farḍ with the same tayammum.

The farā'iḍ of tayammum

1. **Intention**: to make the prayer permissible (not to remove the ḥadath, because tayammum does not lift it).
2. **The first strike**: placing both palms on the earth.
3. **Wiping the face**, all of it.
4. **Wiping the hands to the wrists.** (Wiping to the elbows is a sunnah.)
5. **Continuity**, and **connecting it to the prayer**: praying straight after it.
6. Using **ṣaʿīd ṭayyib**.

How: strike the earth with both palms, wipe your face; strike again, and wipe your right hand and forearm to the elbow with your left palm, then the left with the right. Tayammum is broken by whatever breaks wuḍū', and by **finding water** before starting the prayer, if there is time to use it. One who finds water after praying does not repeat the prayer (it is recommended for some, within the time).

Wiping over khuffs

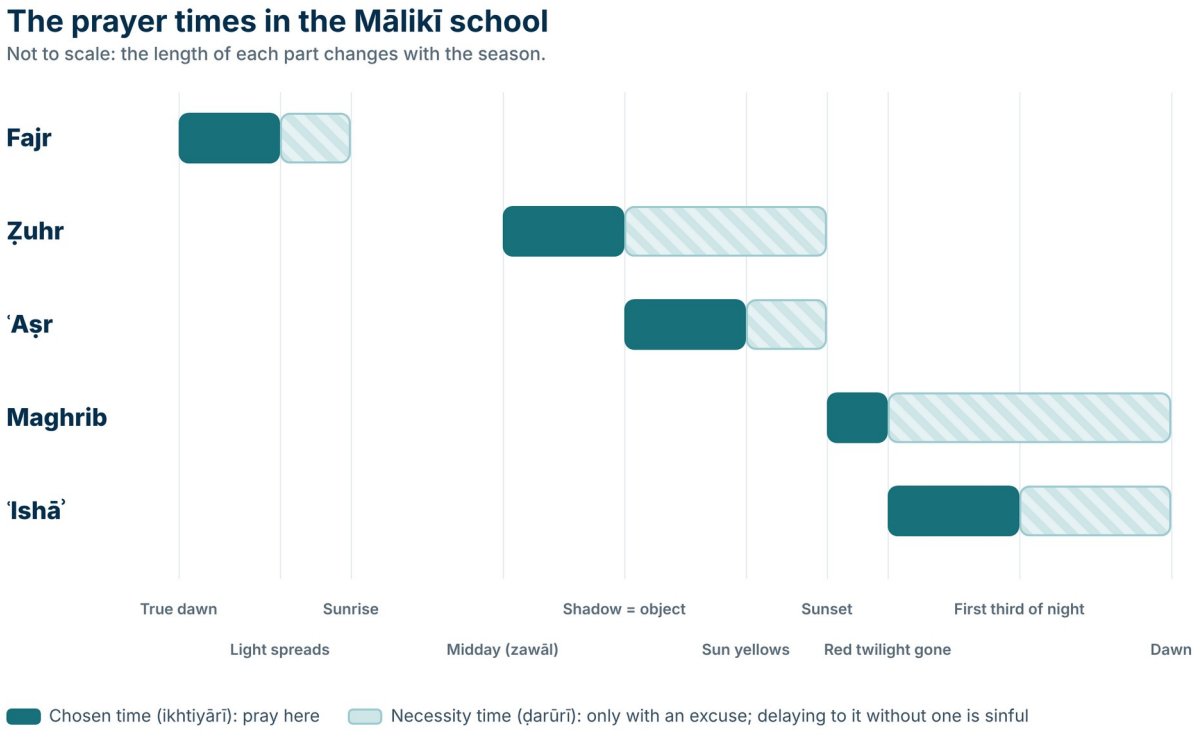
Wiping over **khuffs** (leather socks or boots) in place of washing the feet is permitted for resident and traveller, with **no fixed time limit** in the Mālikī school, though it is recommended to take them off every Friday. Its conditions: they are of **leather**, pure, cover the feet to the ankles, can be walked in, and were put on after a **complete wuḍūʾ** with water. One wipes the top of each khuff with the right hand from the toes to the ankle, and the bottom with the left. Taking them off breaks the wiping: wash the feet straight away.

For students

The well-known Mālikī view permits wiping only over **leather** khuffs, or over cloth socks covered in leather. Wiping over ordinary cotton or nylon socks is not part of the school, though other schools permit it with conditions. Follow your teacher on this.

Part 5 The prayer: times and conditions

The five prayers are obligatory on every Muslim who is **sane** and has reached **puberty**. Children are told to pray at seven and disciplined for it at ten (Abū Dāwūd, 495). Each prayer has a **chosen time** (al-waqt al-ikhtiyārī), when it should be prayed, and a **necessity time** (al-waqt aḍ-ḍarūrī), for people with an excuse such as sleep, forgetfulness, the end of menstruation or a sick person recovering.



Prayer	Rakʿahs	Chosen time	Necessity time
Fajr (aṣ-Ṣubḥ)	2, aloud	From true dawn until the light spreads (isfār)	Until sunrise
Ẓuhr	4, silent	From midday until an object's shadow equals its height (plus its midday shadow)	Until sunset
ʿAṣr	4, silent	From then until the sun turns yellow	Until sunset
Maghrib	3, first two aloud	Just after sunset, long enough to purify and pray it: pray it promptly	Until dawn
ʿIshāʾ	4, first two aloud	From the disappearance of the red twilight until the end of the first third of the night	Until dawn

It is **forbidden** to pray voluntary prayers from after Fajr until the sun is well risen, and from after ʿAṣr until after Maghrib, except that missed obligatory prayers may be made up at any time. Praying at the beginning of the time is best.

The conditions of the prayer

Condition	Detail
Islām, sanity, puberty	Conditions of the obligation.
The time has entered	A prayer before its time is not valid.
Purity from ḥadath	Wuḍūʾ, or ghusl when needed, or tayammum.
Purity from najāsah	Of body, clothes and place, for the one who remembers and is able.
Covering the ʿawrah	For a man, from the navel to the knee; for a woman, the whole body except the face and hands. Clothing must not be see-through.
Facing the qiblah	Towards the Kaʿbah. Whoever cannot see it faces its direction, by his best effort. Excused in great fear and in voluntary prayers on a mount while travelling.

Part 6 The farāʾiḍ, sunan and faḍāʾil of the prayer

The farāʾiḍ: without them there is no prayer

No.	Farḍ	No.	Farḍ
1	Intention (niyyah) of the specific prayer	9	Rising from sujūd (sitting between the two)
2	Takbīrat al-iḥrām: "Allāhu akbar", and nothing else	10	The final salām: "as-salāmu ʿalaykum"
3	Standing for the takbīrat al-iḥrām	11	Sitting for the salām
4	Reciting al-Fātiḥah	12	Stillness (ṭumaʾnīnah) in every position
5	Standing for al-Fātiḥah	13	Straightening up (iʿtidāl)
6	Rukūʿ (bowing)	14	Order between the farāʾiḍ
7	Rising from rukūʿ	15	For one praying behind an imām: the intention to follow him
8	Sujūd on the forehead		

The follower does not recite al-Fātiḥah in the loud prayers; he listens. In the silent prayers and silent rakʿahs it is recommended for him to recite.

The sunan

- The **sūrah** after al-Fātiḥah in the first two rakʿahs, and standing for it
- Reciting **aloud** where it is aloud, and **silently** where it is silent
- Every **takbīr** except the opening one
- "**Samiʿa Allāhu liman ḥamidah**" for the imām and one praying alone
- Each **tashahhud**, and sitting for it
- Prostrating on the **nose**, knees and toes
- For the follower: returning the imām's salām, and the salām of the one on his left
- Saying the salām **aloud**
- Ṣalāh ʿalā an-Nabī ﷺ after the final tashahhud (some count it a faḍīlah)

The faḍāʾil

Raising the hands at the opening takbīr; "**Rabbanā wa laka al-ḥamd**" for the follower and one alone; "**Āmīn**" after al-Fātiḥah (for the imām in silent prayers); glorification in rukūʿ and sujūd; **qunūt** in Fajr, silently, before rukūʿ in the second rakʿah; duʿāʾ before the salām; moving the right index finger in the tashahhud; long recitation in Fajr and Ẓuhr, medium in ʿIshāʾ, short in ʿAṣr and Maghrib; and making the first sitting shorter than the last.

For students

The hands while standing. The well-known view of the school (al-mashhūr) is **sadl**: letting the hands hang at the sides in the obligatory prayer. **Qabḍ**, placing the right hand on the left, is reported from Mālik in the Muwaṭṭaʾ, and many great Mālikī scholars held it to be sunnah. Both are practised by Mālikīs today; follow your teacher.

Opening supplication, taʿawwudh and basmalah. In the obligatory prayer, the well-known view is that these are disliked before al-Fātiḥah. Some later Mālikī scholars recommend saying the basmalah silently, to leave the difference of opinion.

Part 7 The prayer step by step

Here are two rakʿahs, as in Fajr, for one praying alone. Face the qiblah, with the intention in your heart of the specific prayer.

1. Raise your hands to the level of your shoulders and say "**Allāhu akbar**".
2. Recite **al-Fātiḥah**, then "Āmīn", then a **sūrah** or some verses.
3. Say "Allāhu akbar" and **bow**: back straight, hands on knees. Say "**Subḥāna rabbiya al-ʿaẓīm**" (Glory be to my Lord, the Most Great), as many times as you like. Be still.
4. Rise, saying "**Samiʿa Allāhu liman ḥamidah**" (Allah hears the one who praises Him), and when upright, "**Rabbanā wa laka al-ḥamd**" (Our Lord, and Yours is the praise). Stand still.
5. Say "Allāhu akbar" and go down into **sujūd**: forehead and nose on the ground, palms flat beside the face, elbows away from the sides, toes on the ground. Say "**Subḥāna rabbiya al-aʿlā**" (Glory be to my Lord, the Most High), and make duʿāʾ. Be still.
6. Say "Allāhu akbar" and **sit**: sitting on the left hip with the left foot under the right shin (tawarruk), the right foot upright. Be still; you may say "Rabbi ighfir lī". Then the **second sujūd** as the first.
7. Stand for the **second rakʿah** with "Allāhu akbar", and repeat as the first. In Fajr, it is recommended to make **qunūt** silently after the recitation, before bowing.
8. After the second sujūd of the second rakʿah, sit and recite the **tashahhud**, then the **ṣalāh ʿalā an-Nabī** ﷺ, then a duʿāʾ.
9. Say "**As-salāmu ʿalaykum**" once, turning your head slightly to the right.

The tashahhud of the Mālikī school

التَّحِيَّاتُ لِلَّهِ، الزَّاكِيَاتُ لِلَّهِ، الطَّيِّبَاتُ الصَّلَوَاتُ لِلَّهِ، السَّلَامُ عَلَيْكَ أَيُّهَا النَّبِيُّ وَرَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ وَبَرَكَاتُهُ، السَّلَامُ عَلَيْنَا وَعَلَى عِبَادِ اللَّهِ الصَّالِحِينَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَٰهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَحْدَهُ لَا شَرِيكَ لَهُ، وَأَشْهَدُ أَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا عَبْدُهُ وَرَسُولُهُ

“Greetings are for Allah; pure deeds are for Allah; good words and prayers are for Allah. Peace be upon you, O Prophet, and the mercy of Allah and His blessings. Peace be upon us and upon the righteous servants of Allah. I bear witness that there is no god but Allah alone, without partner, and I bear witness that Muḥammad is His servant and His Messenger.”

The tashahhud ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb taught from the minbar, chosen by Imām Mālik (al-Muwaṭṭaʾ, Book of Prayer). “Waḥdahu lā sharīka lah” is added in the Risālah.

The ṣalāh ʿalā an-Nabī ﷺ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ، وَبَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ، فِي الْعَالَمِينَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

“O Allah, send prayers upon Muḥammad and the family of Muḥammad, as You sent prayers upon Ibrāhīm and the family of Ibrāhīm; and bless Muḥammad and the family of Muḥammad, as You blessed Ibrāhīm and the family of Ibrāhīm, among all the worlds. You are Praiseworthy, Glorious.”

Narrated by Mālik in al-Muwaṭṭaʾ and Muslim (405), from Abū Masʿūd al-Anṣārī.

Three and four rakʿahs

In Maghrib, ʿIshāʾ, Ẓuhr and ʿAṣr, sit after the second rakʿah for the **first tashahhud** only, then stand with “Allāhu akbar” for the remaining rakʿahs, reciting **al-Fātiḥah only**, silently. Sit for the final tashahhud after the last rakʿah. When praying behind an imām, the follower makes the salām to the

right, then returns the imām's salām facing forward, and then the salām of the one on his left, if there is someone.

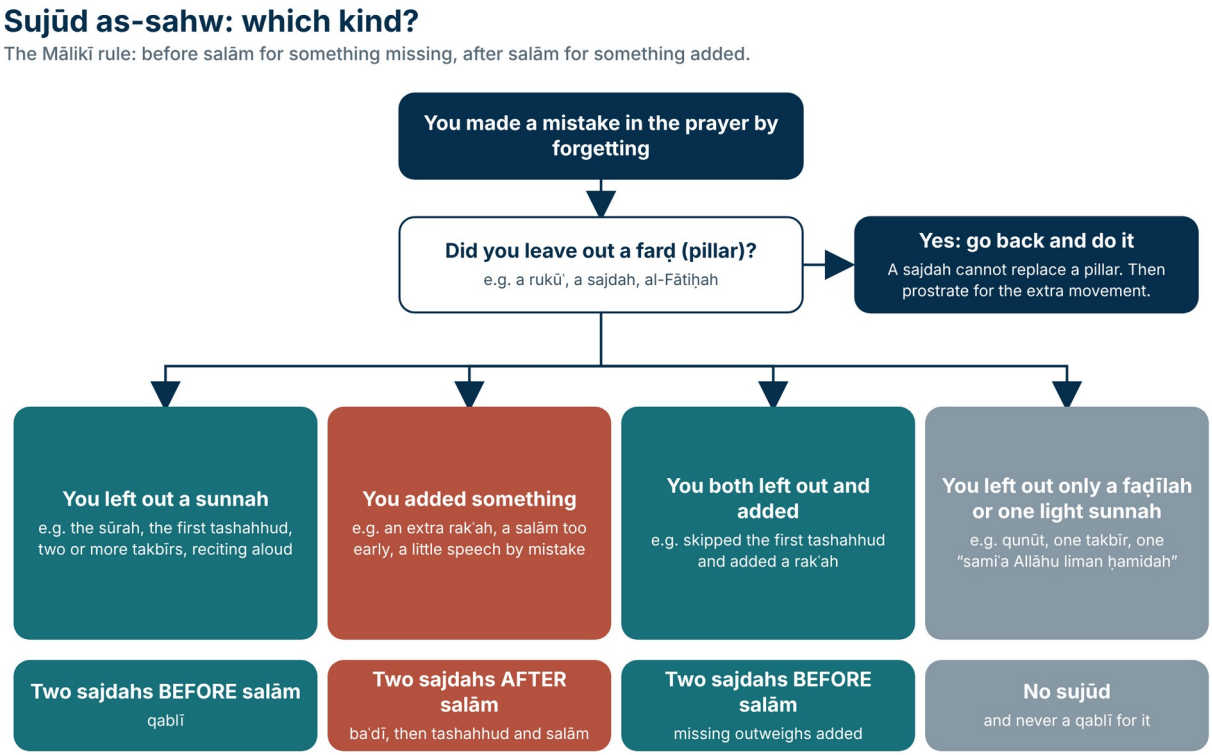
Part 8 What spoils the prayer, and sujūd as-sahw

What makes the prayer invalid

What spoils it	Detail
Leaving a farḍ	Deliberately, or by forgetting without making it up.
A ḥadath	Anything that breaks wuḍūʾ, during the prayer.
Deliberate speech	Except a little to correct the imām when tasbīḥ does not work.
Laughing aloud	Smiling does not spoil it.
Eating or drinking	Even a little, deliberately.
A deliberate addition	Adding a rukūʿ, a sajdah or a rakʿah on purpose.
Much movement	Unrelated movement, enough that an onlooker thinks you are not praying.
Najāsah or uncovering	Najāsah falling on you and staying, or the private parts being uncovered, while you know.
Remembering a missed prayer	If you have five or fewer missed prayers and remember one during a prayer, the order between them is required.

Sujūd as-sahw: the prostration of forgetfulness

Sujūd as-sahw is **two sajdahs** made to repair a mistake made by forgetting. The Mālikī school has a simple and well-known rule:



- **Before salām (qablī)**, for **omission**: after the final tashahhud, make two sajdahs, then repeat the tashahhud and make the salām.
- **After salām (baʿdī)**, for **addition**: make the salām, then two sajdahs, then the tashahhud and the salām again.
- If you **forgot the first tashahhud** and rose: if your hands and knees have not yet left the ground, go back and sit. If they have left the ground, do not go back; continue and make the sujūd before salām.
- If you **forgot a qablī** sujūd and gave salām, make it soon after. If a long time has passed and it was for leaving three sunan or more, the prayer must be repeated.
- Making a **qablī** for leaving only a **faḍīlah** spoils the prayer.
- The follower does not make sujūd for his own forgetting behind the imām; the imām carries it for him. He follows the imām in the imām's sujūd.

The Prophet ﷺ said: "If one of you doubts in his prayer and does not know whether he prayed three or four, let him cast aside the doubt and build on what he is sure of, then prostrate twice" (Muslim, 571). He also made sujūd after salām when he gave salām after two rakʿahs by mistake (al-Bukhārī 482, Muslim 573), and before salām when he forgot the first tashahhud (al-Bukhārī 829, Muslim 570).

Part 9 Travel, missed prayers and Jumuʿah

Shortening the prayer in travel

Shortening the four-rakʿah prayers (Ẓuhr, ʿAṣr and ʿIshāʾ) to **two** is a **confirmed sunnah** for a traveller whose journey is about **four burud** (48 miles, around 80 km or more), for a permissible purpose. He shortens once he has passed the buildings of his town, and continues until he returns, or until he intends to stay somewhere **four full days** (twenty prayers) or more, when he prays in full. Fajr and Maghrib are never shortened. A traveller praying behind a resident imām prays in full with him.

Combining prayers

The traveller may combine Ẓuhr with ʿAṣr and Maghrib with ʿIshāʾ when he is moving. In the Mālikī school, Maghrib and ʿIshāʾ are also combined in the masjid on a night of **heavy rain** or deep mud with darkness, praying ʿIshāʾ early after Maghrib. A sick person who fears losing consciousness may also combine.

Making up missed prayers (qaḍāʾ)

A missed obligatory prayer must be made up **as soon as possible**, at any time, even in the forbidden times. The Prophet ﷺ said: "Whoever forgets a prayer or sleeps through it, its expiation is to pray it when he remembers it" (Muslim, 684). Few missed prayers (five or fewer) are prayed **in order**, and before the present prayer, even if its time is short. Someone with many years of missed prayers makes them up as much as he can each day, with the present prayers, without neglecting his livelihood.

Jumuʿah

Jumuʿah is obligatory on the free, resident, adult Muslim man who has no excuse and lives within about three miles (around 5 km) of the place it is held. It replaces Ẓuhr: two rakʿahs aloud after two khuṭbahs, in a congregation of a settled community in a masjid. Its sunan include **ghusl** connected to going, wearing good clothes and perfume, going early, and listening in silence to the khuṭbah. "If you say to your companion 'Be quiet' on Friday while the imām is giving the khuṭbah, you have engaged in idle talk" (al-Bukhārī 934, Muslim 851). Women, children and travellers are not obliged, but their Jumuʿah is valid if they attend.

Prayer and the person who is ill

Whoever cannot stand prays sitting; whoever cannot sit prays lying on his right side facing the qiblah, then on his back, bowing and prostrating with his head, the sujūd lower than the rukūʿ. The prayer is not dropped as long as the mind is present. "Pray standing; if you cannot, then sitting; if you cannot, then on your side" (al-Bukhārī, 1117).

Test Self-test

Choose the best answer. The answers follow the questions.

1. Water into which najāsah fell is impure when:

a) The water is less than two jugs b) Its colour, taste or smell changes c) Always d) Only if it is still water

2. How many farāʾiḍ does wuḍūʾ have in the Mālikī school?

a) Four b) Five c) Seven d) Ten

3. Which of these is a farḍ of wuḍūʾ in the Mālikī school?

a) Rinsing the mouth b) Wiping the ears c) Saying Bismillāh d) Rubbing (dalk)

4. Running the fingers between each other in wuḍūʾ is:

a) Obligatory b) Disliked c) Not done d) Only for the feet

5. Does bleeding from a cut break wuḍūʾ in the Mālikī school?

a) Yes, always b) Only if it flows c) No d) Only in the prayer

6. Tayammum in the Mālikī school is made:

a) After the prayer time has begun b) Any time of day c) Once a day for all prayers d) Only when travelling

7. What does the hand wipe to, as a farḍ, in tayammum?

a) The elbows b) The wrists c) The fingertips d) The shoulders

8. The chosen time of ʿAṣr ends:

a) At sunset b) When the sun turns yellow c) At Maghrib's adhān d) At midday

9. Which of these is a sunnah, not a farḍ, of the prayer?

a) Al-Fātiḥah b) Rukūʿ c) The sūrah after al-Fātiḥah d) Stillness

10. You forgot the first tashahhud and stood up fully. What do you do?

a) Sit back down b) Continue, and make sujūd before salām c) Start again d) Make sujūd after salām

11. You prayed five rakʿahs of Ẓuhr by mistake. When is your sujūd as-sahw?

a) Before salām b) After salām c) There is none d) In the next prayer

12. You are unsure whether you prayed three or four rakʿahs. You:

a) Assume four b) Start again c) Assume three, complete, and make sujūd after salām d) Ask the person beside you

13. A traveller shortens the prayer when he intends to stay somewhere:

a) Less than four full days b) More than a week c) At least a month d) Over a year

14. How many salāms does the imām or one praying alone make in the Mālikī school?

a) None b) One, to the right c) Two d) Three

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	b) Its qualities change	8	b) When the sun turns yellow
2	c) Seven	9	c) The sūrah
3	d) Rubbing (dalk)	10	b) Continue, sujūd before salām
4	a) Obligatory	11	b) After salām
5	c) No	12	c) Assume three, sujūd after salām
6	a) After the time begins	13	a) Less than four full days
7	b) The wrists	14	b) One, to the right

Activities

1 Make wuḍūʾ slowly while a friend or parent reads the seven farāʾiḍ aloud. Which did you nearly miss?

.....

.....

2 Write the times of the five prayers in your town today, and mark the end of each chosen time.

.....

.....

3 Learn the Mālikī tashahhud by heart this week. Recite it to your teacher.

.....

.....

For further study

- **Matn al-Akhḍarī**, the chapters on purification, prayer and sujūd as-sahw, with a teacher's explanation.
- **Al-Muqaddimah al-ʿAshmāwiyyah**, on purification and prayer.
- **Ar-Risālah** of Ibn Abī Zayd al-Qayrawānī, and **al-Murshid al-Muʿīn** of Ibn ʿĀshir, for the next level.
- **Al-Muwaṭṭaʾ** of Imām Mālik, the Book of Purification and the Book of Prayer.

Learn fiqh with the Himaayah Madrasah

Mālikī fiqh from al-Akhḍarī to the Risālah, taught step by step by qualified teachers, live, five classes a week.

Find your level: himaayahschools.com/placement · **Enrol:** himaayahschools.com/enroll

Madrasah line (WhatsApp): +234 702 584 2849

وَمَا تَوْفِيقِي إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ

“And my success is only through Allah.” (Hūd 11:88)

This guide is for personal and family use. Please do not resell it. © Himaayah Schools, 2026.

Pray as you saw him pray.

This guide from the Himaayah Madrasah teaches the fiqh of purification and prayer according to the school of Imām Mālik, following al-Akhḍarī, al-ʿAshmāwiyyah and the Risālah.

- Water, najāsah and istinjāʾ
- The farāʾiḍ, sunan and nullifiers of wuḍūʾ, ghusl and tayammum
- Prayer times, conditions, pillars and sunan
- The prayer step by step, with the Arabic
- Sujūd as-sahw made simple, with a decision chart

Learn fiqh with the Himaayah Madrasah

Mālikī fiqh from al-Akhḍarī to the Risālah, taught live by qualified teachers, five classes a week.

himaayahschools.com/madrasah